

T-Mobile is Now the
Best Network

Best Mobile Network in the U.S.
According to Ookla® Speedtest®

Based on analysis by Ookla of Speedtest Intelligence® data 1H 2025. Ookla trademarks used under license and reprinted with permission.

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4

 Rain 67/59 • Tomorrow: Showers 64/57 B24

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2025 • \$6

As ceasefire deal holds, next days are crucial

Sides make preparations for hostage and prisoner release, Gaza aid surge

BY CLAIRE PARKER,
LOUISA LOVELUCK
AND LIOR SOROKA

SHARM EL-SHEIKH, EGYPT — Israeli hospitals prepared to receive hostages who have been held in Gaza for more than two years. Israel's prison service transferred "national security prisoners" overnight to prepare them for release. The United Nations and other organizations prepared to surge humanitarian aid into the war-battered enclave.

One day in, the fragile, hard-fought ceasefire between Israel and Hamas appeared Saturday to be holding. But key steps to be executed in the next few days will determine whether the deal brokered in this Red Sea resort can lead to a lasting peace.

Israeli troops withdrew from parts of Gaza when the ceasefire took effect at noon Friday. On Saturday, Israeli commanders led U.S. special envoy Steve Witkoff, Jared Kushner and U.S. commanders on a "field tour" of the enclave, the Israel Defense Forces said. Lt. Gen. Eyal Zamir, the
SEE GAZA ON A17

DIANE KEATON 1946-2025

‘Annie Hall’ star, rom-com legend and a fashion force

BY SAMANTHA CHERY
AND AVI SELK

Academy Award-winning actress Diane Keaton has died at age 79, according to representatives.

Rizzoli, the publishing company for Ms. Keaton's recent book on fashion, confirmed her passing to The Washington Post. People magazine first reported Ms. Keaton's death, saying she died Saturday in her home state of California. The outlet quoted a spokesperson saying there were no further details available and that the family had asked for privacy.

"She was herself at all times and in all ways: extremely thoughtful, very funny, generous to a fault, always energetically hardworking, and just plain true to people in the best possible ways," Rizzoli publisher and editorial director Charles Miers wrote in a statement. "... We are so honored to have worked with her, proud of
SEE KEATON ON A18



VAIL MOUNTAIN RESCUE GROUP

THE GREAT UNKNOWN

On a gray afternoon this spring, Ben Vanek arrived at the Eagle County Sheriff's office in the Colorado high country to collect his late wife's belongings. By his side was their 21-year-old daughter, Haley, who was just a toddler when Michelle Vanek vanished during a hike on Sept. 24, 2005.

An officer greeted Ben and Haley with two white boxes and two brown paper bags and then read a list of what was inside each: The inventory included a cracked hiking pole, a weathered backpack, a crushed water bottle and a silver camera, which Michelle had used to photograph the last known moments of her life.

Ben's eyes wandered to the wall, where a framed map had hung for nearly two decades. Search-and-rescue workers had scoured Mount of the Holy Cross, a 14,005-foot peak where Michelle had disappeared, without any sign of the 35-year-old

A lost hiker, an inspired search and a family left with questions

BY ROMAN STUBBS IN EDWARDS, COLO.



FAMILY PHOTO

Michelle Vanek vanished near the summit of Mount of the Holy Cross in Colorado in 2005.

mother of four. The sheriff had vowed to leave the map of the mountain up as a reminder to never stop looking for her. He finally snatched it off the wall.

"Now that she's been found and we brought her back, we're taking this down. Would you like to have it?" he asked Ben.

"Yes, I would," Ben told him.

With Michelle's belongings in tow, Ben and Haley drove a few miles to meet with the volunteers who had discovered her remains months earlier. They scanned the map and studied photos of the search on conference room tables. None of it fully explained what had happened.

For years, Michelle's disappearance mystified investigators and tormented the small communities surrounding the mountain. Hundreds of people need to be rescued in the North American backcountry every year — in this corner of Colorado
SEE HIKER ON A10



OKSANA PARAFENIUK/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Solomiia, 9, middle, stands in the doorway of a rescue bus after escaping from Russian-occupied southern Ukraine.

A family's emotional journey ends with reunion, separation

Ukrainian girl adjusts after return to her mother

BY LIZZIE JOHNSON AND KOSTIANTYN KHUDOV

The rescue workers have been waiting at the Ukrainian border for days — but still, there is no sign of the 9-year-old girl and her grandmother.

They know little about the pair, only their names and a photo to better recognize them. Solomiia and her grandma — whom she calls Bunia — are the stragglers of the latest group of Ukrainians fleeing Russian occu-

pation on this morning in early June.

Aided by a secret network of volunteers, their journey spans thousands of miles, cutting through Russia, past multiple checkpoints intended to keep people like them from leaving. Even a text message found in support of Ukraine can justify arrest, so Bunia has left her
SEE UKRAINE ON A12



SCOTT SUCHMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Fall dining guide

In a 40-page special section, check out Tom Sietsema's top 40 D.C.-area restaurants.

NATION

Biden struggles to adjust to private life as Trump, Democrats attack. **A4**

SPORTS

He's become the NFL's most powerful agent — and Jerry Jones's foil. **B1**

BUSINESS

The next phase of Trump's fight against solar has begun. **B11**

BOOK WORLD

In his new book, Julian Brave NoiseCat tends to old family wounds.

COMICS.....INSERT
CROSSWORD.....E14
METRO NEWS.....B18
OBITUARIES.....B21
OPINION PAGES.....A21
WORLD NEWS.....A16

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post / Year 148, No. 54367



Phone + 5G home internet
Exclusive savings for customers 55+